TryHackMe Room Writeup 5 of 6

TryHackMe: Windows Fundamentals 1

Network Traffic Analysis, Nmap and Windows Logging | Week 2 | Lab Part

Room detail	Details
Platform	TryHackMe
Room	Windows Fundamentals 1
Room link	https://tryhackme.com/room/windowsfundamentals1xbx
Public profile	https://tryhackme.com/p/hariniedward
Status	Completed, 100%
About the room	Part 1 of the Windows Fundamentals module: the Windows desktop, the NTFS file system, UAC, the Control Panel and more.

Objective

The first part of the Windows Fundamentals module gives a general tour of the Windows operating system. It covers the desktop, the NTFS file system, the System32 folder, user accounts, User Account Control, the Control Panel and Task Manager.

What I learned

- Windows editions: Windows 11 comes in Home and Pro, and Pro adds extra features such as drive encryption. The lab machine ran Windows Server 2019.
- The desktop is built from the Desktop, Start menu, search box, Task View, taskbar, toolbars and the notification area. Most of these can be changed by right clicking.
- NTFS replaced FAT16, FAT32 and HPFS. It supports files over 4 GB, file and folder permissions, compression, encryption with EFS, and it is a journaling file system that can repair itself after a failure.
- NTFS permissions are Full control, Modify, Read and Execute, List folder contents, Read and Write, and they are set from the Security tab of a file or folder.
- Alternate Data Streams let a file hold extra hidden data. Windows itself uses them to mark files downloaded from the internet, but malware authors also use them to hide data.
- The Windows folder holds the operating system and is reached with the %windir% variable. System32 holds critical files, and deleting them can break Windows.
- There are two main account types, Administrator and Standard User. User profiles live in C:\Users, and accounts and groups are managed with lusrmgr.msc.
- User Account Control asks for approval before an action needs higher privileges, which limits what malware can do silently. By default it does not apply to the built in Administrator account.
- Settings and Control Panel both change the system, and Programs and Features in Control Panel lists installed software.
- Task Manager shows running applications, processes and CPU and memory use.

Key points in a table

Topic	What it is	Security angle
NTFS	The standard Windows file system with permissions, encryption and journaling.	Permissions control who can read or change a file. Alternate Data Streams can hide data.
System32	Folder holding core Windows programs and libraries.	Malware often hides in it or copies its file names.

Topic	What it is	Security angle
User accounts	Administrator and Standard User accounts with profiles in C:\Users.	Too many administrators increase the damage an attacker can do.
UAC	Prompts for approval before elevated actions.	A disabled or bypassed UAC is a warning sign.
Task Manager	Lists processes, performance and services.	A quick way to notice unknown processes.

The practical task

- Used the Start menu and taskbar options to hide the search box and the Task View button, and looked at what sits in the notification area.
- Checked the file system used by the C drive and the permissions on the Windows folder.
- Looked up the system variable for the Windows folder.
- Opened lusrmgr.msc to see the other user account, its group and the built in guest account.
- Saw the UAC shield and prompt when installing a program as the standard user.
- Changed the Control Panel view to small icons and found the shortcut to open Task Manager.

Why this matters for a SOC analyst

- NTFS permissions and ownership help answer who could access or change a file.
- Knowing what belongs in System32 helps spot files that imitate system programs.
- Understanding account types and UAC explains why some actions create privilege related events such as 4672.

> **Key takeaway**
> Understanding permissions, accounts and UAC shows how Windows controls access, and therefore how attackers try to get around that control.

Completion proof



Room page showing 100% completion. My profile details have been removed from the screenshot.

References

Room: https://tryhackme.com/room/windowsfundamentals1xbx

My public profile: https://tryhackme.com/p/hariniedward